



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

ROBERT CERVANTES and others prepare to march in La Puente on June 15 in support of immigrants.

‘You’re scared to be brown’

Jackie Ramirez has always been aware of the color of her skin. There was the school crossing guard who nicknamed her *morenita*, little brown girl. The uncle who affectionately called her *paisita*, a country girl. But never has skin color felt so top of mind than this month, as immigration agents have descended on Southern California, conducting hundreds of arrests. Videos and stories have circulated of people arrested at car washes. Agents picking up street vendors without warrants. A Latino U.S. citizen asked what hospital he was born in. The heightened fear that kicks in for those “driving while Black” is widely

U.S.-born Latinos fear racial profiling and harassment during ICE raids in the Southland

By Brittney Mejia

known. But the recent immigration sweeps have underscored how much of an issue skin color — and all the circumstances that attach to it — is for Latinos as well. Ramirez was born and raised in East Los Angeles. Her mother was born in Mexico; her father is of Mexican descent. “You’re scared to be brown,” said Ramirez, a Los Angeles radio host for “The Cruz Show” on Real 92.3. “You’re scared to look a certain way right now.” The Department of Homeland Security has denied that agents are racially profiling. Agency spokesperson Tricia McLaughlin [See Profiling, A14]

U.S. tells state: Trans rules in sports hurt girls

Education secretary alleges Title IX violation, threatens to withhold funding.

By Jenny Jarvie, Jaweed Kaleem and Howard Blume

The U.S. Department of Education announced Wednesday that California and the California Interscholastic Federation violated the civil rights of female students on the basis of sex by allowing transgender athletes to compete in school sports according to their gender identity. Having concluded its investigation, the Trump administration is calling on California to “voluntarily agree” to change what it determined are “unlawful practices” within 10 days or risk “imminent enforcement action.” “Although Governor Gavin Newsom admitted months ago it was ‘deeply unfair’ to allow men to compete in women’s sports, both the California Department of Education and the California Interscholastic Federation continued as recently as a few weeks ago to allow men to steal female athletes’ well-deserved accolades and to subject them to the indignity of unfair and unsafe competitions,” U.S. Secretary of Education

Linda McMahon said in a statement. “The Trump Administration will relentlessly enforce Title IX protections for women and girls, and our findings today make clear that California has failed to adhere to its obligations under federal law. The state must swiftly come into compliance with Title IX or face the consequences that follow.” [See Title IX, A6]

Provision in state’s insurance is illegal, judge says

FAIR Plan’s coverage for smoke damage claims is ruled to be in violation of code.

By Laurence Darmiento

In a landmark decision, a Los Angeles judge has ruled that California’s home insurer of last resort is violating state law by how it treats smoke damage claims — a policy that homeowners have long complained shortchanges them, including, most recently, victims of the Jan. 7 firestorms. Los Angeles County Superior Court Judge Stuart Rice on Tuesday said that the California FAIR Plan Assn.’s policy violates the insurance code because it provides less coverage than what is required by the state’s Standard Form Fire Insurance Policy, which provides coverage for all “loss by fire” damage without making any distinction for smoke damage. Since 2017, the plan has required that fire claims must result in “direct physical loss” as defined by “permanent physical changes” to a property, which owners allege has made it more difficult to be compensated for smoke damage. The plan issued a notice to its customers that year that said the new definition of direct physical loss “will result in the denial of claims that might have been paid under prior policy wording,” Rice noted in his decision in a case brought by a former Mono County property owner. “This notice seems to ad- [See Smoke, A11]

STATE LEADERS REACH BUDGET DEAL

Plan aims to cut healthcare spending for immigrants in face of \$12-billion deficit.

By Taryn Luna

California leaders reached a tentative agreement Tuesday on the state budget, which hinges on Gov. Gavin Newsom’s demand that the Legislature pass a housing reform proposal. The eleventh-hour negotiations about the spending plan, which takes effect July 1, speak to the political challenge of overhauling long-standing environmental regulations to speed up housing construction in a state controlled by Democrats. The party has been loath to do more than tweak the California Environmental Quality Act, or approve one-off exemptions, despite pressure from the governor and national criticism of a law that reform advocates say has hamstrung California’s ability to build. The proposal is among a series of policies Newsom and Democratic lawmakers are expected to advance in the coming days as part of the \$321.1-billion budget. The deal reflects the Legislature’s resistance to the governor’s proposed cuts to reduce a \$12-billion budget deficit expected in the year ahead, citing uncertainty about the scope of the state’s financial problems. “We appreciate the strong partnership with the Legislature in reaching this budget agreement,” said Izzy Gardon, a spokesperson for Newsom. “The governor’s signature is contingent on finalizing legislation to cut red tape and unleash housing and infrastructure development.” [See Budget, A7]

ANALYSIS

Trump’s high-stakes Iran gambit

President’s military action garners wide support, along with questions



BEATA ZAWRZEL NurPhoto

PRESIDENT Trump with Turkish leader Recep Tayyip Erdogan on Wednesday.

Will Tehran stick to truce?

Questions mount over the impact of the U.S. and Israeli onslaught on Iran’s nuclear facilities. PERSPECTIVES, A2

Trump’s all in on NATO

Members of the alliance appease the president by agreeing to spend 5% of their GDP on defense. WORLD, A3

By Michael Wilner

THE HAGUE — President Trump’s gamble in bombing Iran offers significant rewards if it succeeded in destroying Tehran’s nuclear program — and historic risks if it did not. He will get credit for success only if he acknowledges the consequences of failure. There are critics of Trump’s decision to order strikes against Iran’s nuclear facilities over the weekend. A segment of the president’s base is worried about another military entanglement in the Middle East, and a contingent of Democrats are concerned that he operated outside his constitutional authorities to wage war. But majority support exists on a bipartisan basis across Washington and among U.S. allies in Europe and the Middle East for the president’s military actions, which was on display at the NATO summit in The [See Analysis, A4]

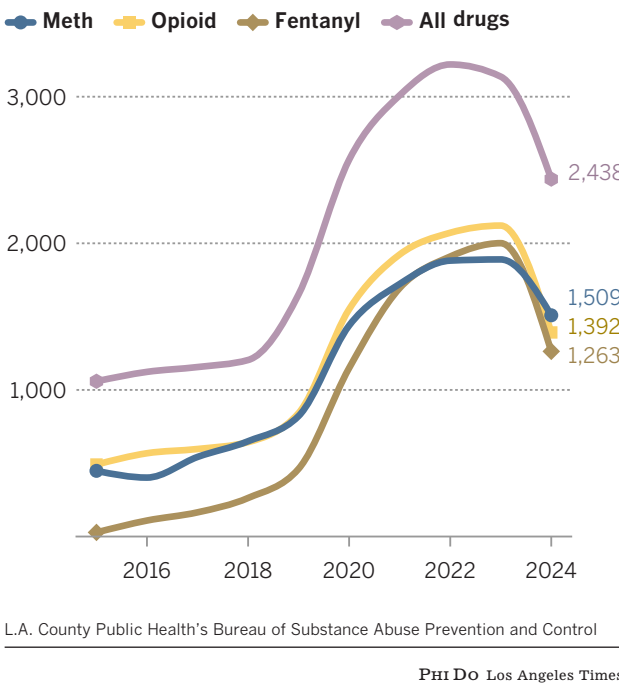
Overdose deaths plummet in county

Health officials credit drug treatment and prevention measures for lower toll in 2024.

By Marcos Magaña

Accidental drug overdose and poisoning deaths plunged by 22% in Los Angeles County last year, according to a new report, marking the most substantial single-year decline on record. The 2024 overdose death toll of 2,438 is the lowest since 2019 and a notable drop from the 3,137 deaths recorded in 2023. The sharpest decline was in fentanyl-related deaths, which fell 37% from 2,001 deaths in 2023 to 1,263 in 2024, according to a report released Wednesday by the L.A. County Public Health Department. Health officials credited measures including large-scale investments in drug

Accidental drug overdose deaths in L.A. County are decreasing



treatment and overdose prevention for the reversal of a long upward trend. “It demonstrates that what we’re doing is working,” said Dr. Gary Tsai, director of the county’s Substance Abuse Prevention and Control division, citing increased prevention measures and other efforts. Even so, the county still suffers “very high numbers of overdose deaths,” Tsai said. “Now is actually the time to be pressing our foot on the gas even more.” While fentanyl remained the leading cause of accidental overdose deaths, its share dropped to 52% of all cases, down from 64% in 2023. Deaths involving methamphetamine also declined, by 20%, the report said. Dr. Pope Moseley, a lung and intensive care physician and biomedical sciences researcher at Arizona State University, welcomed the [See Health, A7]

LAUSD budget delays layoffs

But the \$18.8-billion spending plan includes cuts to retiree contributions. CALIFORNIA, B1

Homelessness efforts stay put

Judge denies activists’ request to shift control from the city to a receiver. CALIFORNIA, B1

Film tax credit is poised to rise

State leaders agree to raise the cap for incentives to \$750 million a year. BUSINESS, A9

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 81/61. B6

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